T'CHALLA / BLACK PANTHER

Since his first comic-book appearance in *Fantastic Four #52* in 1966, Black Panther has been equally powerful and enigmatic. Translating T'Challa's iconic prowess from comic to screen was a task Ryan Meinerding approached with fervent excitement. "I tend to like to design the 'men-of-action' of the Marvel Cinematic Universe. I find the ones I'm drawn to are the more physical ones, the ones who specialize in hand-to-hand combat. Panther's silhouette throughout the comics has always been lithe, and because the costume is primarily black with muscle shapes, the challenge with this one was trying to find a way to translate something that's simple to a real-world setting with enough texture and detail to not just be a man in a black leotard. I was trying to come up with ways of having the suit constructed that the audience wouldn't understand—it's meant to be woven together in ways that are nearly impossible to achieve in a practical setting, and therefore make it feel like it's from a culture that's way more advanced than ours."

Ryan Meinerding concept art.